

# Fancy Bass Chords

and Their Voicings

(B) E A D G



<https://fancychords.com>

## Movable Shapes

Bass closed, so they move

shape root on bottom example

### fifths

|      |   |   |            |
|------|---|---|------------|
| 02xx | E | R | 13xx = F5  |
| x02x | A | R | x13x = Bb5 |
| xx02 | D | R | xx13 = Eb5 |
| 3x0x | E | R | 4x1x = Ab5 |

### major

|      |   |   |           |
|------|---|---|-----------|
| 02x1 | E | R | 13x2 = F  |
| 320x | E | R | 431x = Ab |
| x320 | A | R | x431 = Db |

### minor

|      |   |   |            |
|------|---|---|------------|
| 02x0 | E | R | 13x1 = Fm  |
| 310x | E | R | 421x = Abm |
| x310 | A | R | x421 = Dbm |

- Shape is the fingering above its lowest fret.
- Slide it one fret, the chord rises a semitone.
- Bottom is the degree on the lowest string.

## Root Positions

Bass

|           | (B) | E  | A  | D  | G  |
|-----------|-----|----|----|----|----|
| <b>C</b>  | 1   | 8  | 3  | 10 | 5  |
| <b>Db</b> | 2   | 9  | 4  | 11 | 6  |
| <b>D</b>  | 3   | 10 | 5  | 0  | 7  |
| <b>Eb</b> | 4   | 11 | 6  | 1  | 8  |
| <b>E</b>  | 5   | 0  | 7  | 2  | 9  |
| <b>F</b>  | 6   | 1  | 8  | 3  | 10 |
| <b>Gb</b> | 7   | 2  | 9  | 4  | 11 |
| <b>G</b>  | 8   | 3  | 10 | 5  | 0  |
| <b>Ab</b> | 9   | 4  | 11 | 6  | 1  |
| <b>A</b>  | 10  | 5  | 0  | 7  | 2  |
| <b>Bb</b> | 11  | 6  | 1  | 8  | 3  |
| <b>B</b>  | 0   | 7  | 2  | 9  | 4  |

Fret for the root of each key on each string. Everything else is measured from there.

## Patterns

Bass counted from the root

### Root + fifth + octave

The default. Works under

anything in the key.

|        |    |     |     |
|--------|----|-----|-----|
| degree | R  | 5   | 8   |
| string | R  | 1+R | 2+R |
| fret   | R0 | R2  | R2  |

### Major arpeggio

Major, maj7, 6.

|        |    |     |     |     |
|--------|----|-----|-----|-----|
| degree | R  | 5   | 8   | 3   |
| string | R  | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret   | R0 | R2  | R2  | R1  |

### Minor arpeggio

Minor, m7, m6.

|        |    |     |     |     |
|--------|----|-----|-----|-----|
| degree | R  | 5   | 8   | b3  |
| string | R  | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret   | R0 | R2  | R2  | R0  |

### Dominant seventh

Any 7 chord. The b7 pulls to

the four.

|        |    |     |     |     |
|--------|----|-----|-----|-----|
| degree | R  | 5   | b7  | 3   |
| string | R  | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret   | R0 | R2  | R0  | R1  |

### Minor seventh

The two and the six chord.

|        |    |     |     |     |
|--------|----|-----|-----|-----|
| degree | R  | 5   | b7  | b3  |
| string | R  | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret   | R0 | R2  | R0  | R0  |

### Walking approach

Leading into the next chord.

|        |    |     |     |     |
|--------|----|-----|-----|-----|
| degree | R  | 5   | 6   | b7  |
| string | R  | 1+R | 1+R | 2+R |
| fret   | R0 | R2  | R4  | R0  |

## Numbers

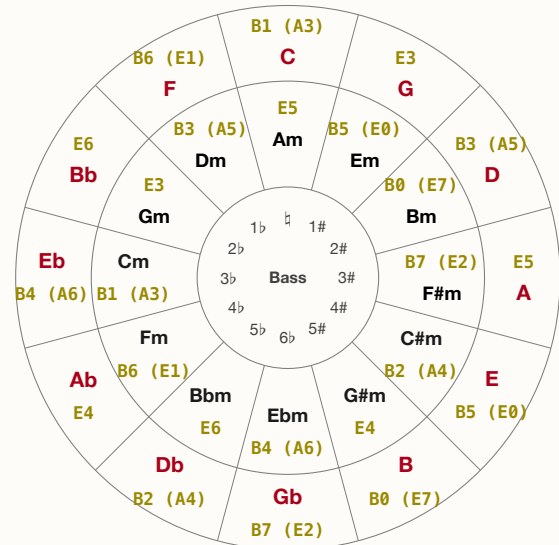
Bass the major scale, degree by degree

|                | 1              | 2              | 3              | 4              | 5              | 6              | 7              |
|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| C              | C              | D              | E              | F              | G              | A              | B              |
| D <sup>b</sup> | D <sup>b</sup> | E <sup>b</sup> | F              | G <sup>b</sup> | A <sup>b</sup> | B <sup>b</sup> | C              |
| D              | D              | E              | F <sup>#</sup> | G              | A              | B              | C <sup>#</sup> |
| E <sup>b</sup> | E <sup>b</sup> | F              | G              | A <sup>b</sup> | B <sup>b</sup> | C              | D              |
| E              | E              | F <sup>#</sup> | G <sup>#</sup> | A              | B              | C <sup>#</sup> | D <sup>#</sup> |
| F              | F              | G              | A              | B <sup>b</sup> | C              | D              | E              |
| G <sup>b</sup> | G <sup>b</sup> | A <sup>b</sup> | B <sup>b</sup> | C <sup>b</sup> | D <sup>b</sup> | E <sup>b</sup> | F              |
| G              | G              | A              | B              | C              | D              | E              | F <sup>#</sup> |
| A <sup>b</sup> | A <sup>b</sup> | B <sup>b</sup> | C              | D <sup>b</sup> | E <sup>b</sup> | F              | G              |
| A              | A              | B              | C <sup>#</sup> | D              | E              | F <sup>#</sup> | G <sup>#</sup> |
| B <sup>b</sup> | B <sup>b</sup> | C              | D              | E <sup>b</sup> | F              | G              | A              |
| B              | B              | C <sup>#</sup> | D <sup>#</sup> | E              | F <sup>#</sup> | G <sup>#</sup> | A <sup>#</sup> |

Read across: in the key on the left, the four is the note under the 4. A minor key borrows the same row, starting from its six.

Bass

## Circle of Fifths



String and fret for each root: **A3** is the third fret of the A string.

Lowest that falls under the hand.

Five-string first, four-string in parentheses.

## Tunings

Bass (B) E A D G

The guitar's lowest four strings, an octave down.

## What to Play Under

Bass degrees from the root

|              |                  |              |                    |
|--------------|------------------|--------------|--------------------|
| <b>major</b> | <b>R 3 5</b>     | <b>°7</b>    | <b>R b3 b5 6</b>   |
| <b>m</b>     | <b>R b3 5</b>    | <b>m7b5</b>  | <b>R b3 b5 b7</b>  |
| <b>5</b>     | <b>R 5</b>       | <b>7sus4</b> | <b>R 4 5 b7</b>    |
| <b>+</b>     | <b>R 3 #5</b>    | <b>7b5</b>   | <b>R 3 b5 b7</b>   |
| <b>°</b>     | <b>R b3 b5</b>   | <b>7#5</b>   | <b>R 3 #5 b7</b>   |
| <b>sus2</b>  | <b>R 2 5</b>     | <b>9</b>     | <b>R 9 3 5 b7</b>  |
| <b>sus4</b>  | <b>R 4 5</b>     | <b>maj9</b>  | <b>R 9 3 5 7</b>   |
| <b>6</b>     | <b>R 3 5 6</b>   | <b>m9</b>    | <b>R 9 b3 5 b7</b> |
| <b>m6</b>    | <b>R b3 5 6</b>  | <b>add9</b>  | <b>R 9 3 5</b>     |
| <b>6/9</b>   | <b>R 9 3 5 6</b> | <b>madd9</b> | <b>R 9 b3 5</b>    |
| <b>7</b>     | <b>R 3 5 b7</b>  | <b>7b9</b>   | <b>R b9 3 5 b7</b> |
| <b>maj7</b>  | <b>R 3 5 7</b>   | <b>7#9</b>   | <b>R b3 3 5 b7</b> |
| <b>m7</b>    | <b>R b3 5 b7</b> | <b>m11</b>   | <b>R 9 b3 4 5</b>  |
|              |                  |              | <b>b7</b>          |

## Fancy Bass Chords and Their Voicings

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Downloads and a printable copy:  
<https://fancychords.com>

Source and corrections:  
<http://github.com/linenoise/voicings>

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Play the root, and the fifth if there is one.  
Add the tone that names the chord, the **b3** or the **b7**, only when it wants hearing.  
The rest belongs to whoever is playing chords.